Phase 1: User & System Problem Identification

User group

Undergraduate students at National Louis University

3. Problem Description

Currently, students at National Louis University do not have access to a dedicated online system for independent course registration and academic planning.

There is no centralized website where students can:

- Register for classes on their own
- View degree requirements for their major
- Track completed and remaining courses
- Plan future semesters

System and technology Involved

Describing where the students face problems.

- Student portal
- Advisor management system
- Email systems
- Manual administrative processes

These systems are not fully integrated and do not provide real-time academic planning support.

System Symptoms and Friction Points

Students cannot register independently

Course information is fragmented

No centralized planning platform

Heavy dependence on advisors

Long response times via email

Repetitive communication

Manual verification of requirements

These symptoms indicate poor system integration and limited automation.

User workarounds

Because of system limitations, students >

1. Send multiple emails to advisors
2. keep personal spreadsheet
3. write down course plans
4. ask fellowmates
5. save screenshots of degree plans

These behaviors show gaps in system design

Traget movement for improvement

The most critical movement before each semester when students must decide which course to take.

At this stage , missing or unclear information can delay graduation and increase student stress